

Cross-Functional Coordination Model

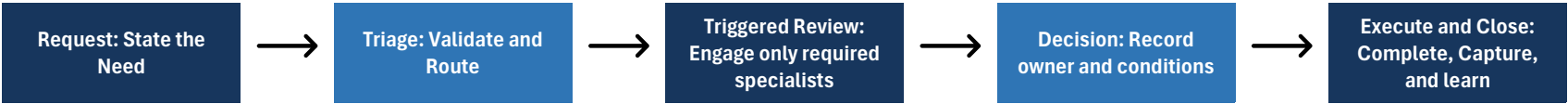
A lightweight operating interface between Deerfield Intelligence and corporate functions

Operating principle

Deerfield Intelligence Operations acts as the strategic orchestrator across recurring cross-functional work. DI and business sponsors own priorities and requirements; specialist functions own policy, judgment and approvals; Operations owns the interface that converts a request into a visible, well-routed and completed workflow.

Layer	Primary accountability
DI / business owner	Defines the objective, business context, priority, timing and accountable owner; makes product and delivery decisions.
Director of Operations	Validates intake, routes work, coordinates handoffs, maintains visibility and escalates exceptions
Specialist functions	HR, Finance, Legal, Compliance, IT and Security apply domain expertise, standards, controls and approval authority.
CIO / executive sponsor	Resolves material priority conflicts, policy exceptions, risk acceptance and decisions that exceed delegated authority.

The one-front-door model (central intake)



Employees should not need to navigate Deerfield's corporate org chart. They should know where to submit a request, what information is required, who owns the next action and when an exception will be escalated. The “front door” is a simple form and shared tracker, not a new department or platform.

Design principles

- Minimum viable process: add only the structure required to scale from 10 to 30 people.
- Proportionate control. Routine, low-risk work follows a fast path; novel, sensitive or material work receives specialist review.
- Visibility by default. Status, next action, owner and aging are visible without reconstructing progress through meetings or messages.
- Exception-based coordination. Async updates are the default; forums exist to make decisions, resolve dependencies and address exceptions.
- No shadow authority. Operations may coordinate and challenge, but does not replace specialist judgment or business accountability.

Model at a glance

Five workflow families use the same operating logic: Request → Triage → Triggered review → Decision → Execution and Close

Workflow family	Typical requests	Accountable owner	Corporate partners	Operations role
A. Portfolio control and delivery coordination	New initiative, reprioritization, cross-pod dependency	CIO / pod lead	Investment team as relevant	Intake, visibility, dependency and escalation
B. Hiring and Onboarding	Role request, recruiting, onboarding, access	Hiring manager / pod lead	HR, IT, Security	Coordinate the end-to-end chain
C. Vendor and data-source coordination	New vendor or data source, contract review, third-party assessment, renewal or termination	Business / budget owner	Finance, Legal, Compliance, Security	One intake and parallel routing
D. Investment team and portco engagement	AI use case, external deployment, portco engagement	Product / engagement owner	Legal, Compliance, Security, investment sponsor	Trigger-based coordination
E. Financial planning and spend management	Forecast update, headcount or spend change, budget variance, funding tradeoff	CIO / budget owner	Finance, hiring and vendor owners	Consolidate assumptions, surface variance, coordinate decisions and track follow-through

Four roles used consistently

Role	Decision right and obligation
Accountable owner	Owns the outcome and final non-specialist decision; supplies context and resources; accepts delivery or ongoing ownership.
Operations orchestrator	Validates the request, sequences the workflow, records decisions, follows through and escalates when triggers are met.
Specialist approver	Applies delegated policy, risk, employment, financial, security or legal authority; approves, conditions, rejects or escalates.
Executor / contributor	Completes defined work or supplies input without inheriting accountability merely by performing a task.

Boundary conditions

- Operations may return incomplete requests, establish service standards, convene owners and require a recorded decision.
- Operations does not approve employment actions, legal terms, compliance risk, security exceptions or unbudgeted expenditure unless authority is expressly delegated.
- The CIO enters only for a portfolio tradeoff, material risk acceptance, policy exception, incremental funding or an impasse between accountable leaders.

A. Portfolio control and delivery coordination

One visible path from demand to an accepted commitment

This workflow combines intake, prioritization, capacity and cross-pod dependency management. Treating them as separate administrative processes would preserve the current failure mode: work can be accepted before capacity and dependencies are understood.

Element	Minimum operating standard
Purpose	Prevent work from being accepted before capacity, dependencies and control requirements are understood.
Intake	Objective, sponsor, users, expected outcome, urgency, date constraint, systems or data involved, and likely dependencies.
Accountable owner	CIO or delegated portfolio forum for priority; initiative owner for delivery.
Triggered partners	Supplying pod leads; Investment team or Legal / Compliance / Security when the work creates a relevant dependency or risk.
Escalation	External date at risk; dependency owner will not commit; work displaces an existing P1/P2 commitment; material risk lacks a decision maker.
Record	Decision, rationale, owner, milestone, definition of done, dependencies, conditions and work displaced.

Workflow

Stage	Lead	Minimum Requirement
1. Submit	Sponsor / requester	Objective, sponsor, urgency and reason, users, desired outcome, date constraint, systems or data involved
2. Triage	Operations	Check completeness; classify investment, portfolio company or internal demand; identify likely control and specialist triggers
3. Assess	Pod lead + dependencies	Size work; identify required pods and functions; supplying owners accept proposed contribution and timing
4. Decide	CIO / delegated forum	(where required) Accept, defer, reject or request discovery using agreed criteria; record rationale and any work displaced
5. Commit	Initiative owner	Confirm accountable owner, milestone, definition of done, dependencies, support path and specialist conditions
6. Review	Weekly operating review	Review exceptions, risks, aging decisions and changes to commitments—not a line-by-line status meeting

Prioritization criteria

Criterion	Decision question
Strategic and investment value	Does the work advance a stated investment, portfolio company or DI objective?
Outcome clarity	Is the intended user, decision or measurable result clear enough to justify capacity?
Timing basis	Is the date externally fixed, risk-driven or merely preferred?
Capacity and opportunity cost	Which pod and specialist capacity is required, and what would be delayed or displaced?
Risk and reversibility	What data, model, regulatory, security, contractual or reputational exposure is created?

B. Hiring and onboarding

A single people workflow from approved need through the first 30 days

Hiring speed and onboarding readiness should be managed as one operating chain. HR retains employment authority; hiring managers retain selection and technical integration; Operations makes the end-to-end path visible and prevents handoff failures.

Element	Minimum operating standard
Purpose	Reduce recruiting and onboarding handoff failures while preserving HR authority and manager accountability.
Intake	Business rationale, role sequence, reporting line, level, location, cost, start trigger and interview capacity.
Accountable owner	Hiring manager / pod lead for selection, technical readiness and integration; HR for the employment process.
Triggered partners	HR for all employment activity; IT and Security for equipment, identity, system and data access.
Escalation	Search lacks interview capacity; finalist decision misses deadline; start is at risk; compensation, title, location or policy needs an exception.
Record	Role approval, stage, next action, candidate decision, start date, readiness checklist, access exceptions and 30-day blockers.

Workflow

Stage	Accountable lead	Core requirements	Specialist / Ops role
1 Plan role	Pod lead + Operations	Link the role to the workforce sequence Confirm business rationale, reporting line, start trigger and cost	HR advises on level, title and policy
2 Approve search	CIO / authorized owner	Approve need and tradeoff Confirm hiring manager and interview capacity	HR validates approval and employment process
3 Recruit and select	Hiring manager + HR	Use committed stages, scorecards, panel owners, feedback deadlines and one visible candidate tracker	Operations monitors aging and removes coordination blockers
4 Prepare start	Operations	Start pre-hire checklist - confirm equipment, identity, baseline access, data permissions, first-week task, buddy and 30-day plan	IT / Security approve and provision; HR completes employment steps
5 Day one and week one	Hiring manager	Provide context, expected outcomes and real work Verify baseline access and relationships	Operations escalates missing access or owner gaps
6 30-day check	Manager + new hire	Review role clarity, access, integration, early output and unresolved dependencies	Operations captures systemic fixes; HR handles employee matters

Ongoing Access: Use the same record for role changes, departures and privileged access. The manager or system owner remains accountable; IT and Security approve and execute under delegated policy; Operations tracks only exceptions and overdue actions.

C. Vendor and data-source coordination

One intake with parallel, risk-based specialist review

Vendor, data-source and cloud commitments should share a common record, while specialist approvals remain distinct. **A request should not move serially through functions when reviews can occur in parallel.**

Element	Minimum operating standard
Purpose	Avoid serial handoffs, duplicate purchases and ownerless commitments while keeping specialist approvals distinct.
Intake	Purpose, users, alternatives, value, cost, timing, data, systems, contract term and ongoing business / technical owner.
Accountable owner	Business owner within approved budget; budget owner for spend and forecast effects.
Triggered partners	Finance, Legal, Compliance and Security only where the request's cost, terms, data, integration or risk profile requires review.
Escalation	Unbudgeted commitment; material or novel risk; policy exception; unresolved terms; missing owner; decision threatens required timing.
Record	Cost, budget, vendor, contract dates, risk tier, approvals and conditions, renewal date, usage and owner.

Workflow

Stage	Participant	Required contribution
1 Request	Business owner	State the need and provide the complete intake.
2 Triage	Operations	Check completeness and duplicates; assign route; launch only required reviews.
3 Review in parallel	Triggered specialists	Finance: budget and approval. Legal: terms and IP. Compliance: use and obligations. Security: access, integration and third-party risk.
4 Decide and contract	Business / budget owner	Record approval, conditions, contracting path, cost and accountable owner.
5 Activate	Business / technical owner	Complete evaluation and access; accept operating and monitoring obligations.
6 Renew or terminate	Business / budget owner	Review use, value, risk, alternatives and forecast impact before notice date.

Risk-tier logic

Tier	Typical trigger	Treatment
Fast path	Low cost; standard terms; no sensitive or restricted data; no privileged integration; known category	Budget confirmation plus required standard checks
Standard review	Material cost, new contract terms, external data, system integration or operational dependency	Finance plus triggered Legal, Compliance and Security review
Exception path	Novel data use, material regulatory or security exposure, policy exception, large unbudgeted commitment	Named specialist authority and CIO / executive decision as required

D. Investment team and portfolio company engagement

Control the initiation and handoff without slowing discovery

Element	Minimum operating standard
Purpose	Make ownership, intended use, evidence and monitoring explicit before build or launch.
Intake	Use case, users, data, model or vendor, decision supported, business authority and expected value.
Accountable owner	Business / product owner for outcome; pod / engagement owner for delivery.
Triggered partners	Legal, Compliance and Security when policy, data, model, contractual or deployment triggers apply.
Escalation	Unapproved deployment; sensitive outbound data; unclear authority; evidence or monitoring gap; material change in scope.
Record	Authority, intended use, conditions, decision, evidence, monitoring owner, launch date and review date.

AI or data initiative workflow

Stage	Lead	Minimum requirement
1 Idea / discovery	Pod or sponsor	State intended use, users, data, model or vendor, decision supported and whether output leaves Deerfield
2 Operations Triage	Operations	Confirm accountable owner; identify sensitive data, external sharing, investment use, production use, client or portco impact
3 Specialist review	Legal / Compliance / Security	Review only where triggers apply; specify conditions, evidence and monitoring required
4 Build and test	Pod owner	Meet specialist conditions; document ownership, intended use, limitations and transition or support path
5 Launch decision	Business owner, specialist authority	Accept business outcome and operating ownership; approve or condition risk within delegated authority
6 Monitor	Product / model owner	Maintain critical knowledge, incidents, material changes and review evidence proportionate to use

Portfolio company engagement workflow

Stage	Accountable lead	Required handoff
1 Engagement initiation	Investment sponsor	Names the company counterpart, objective, strategic rationale and desired outcome
2 Readiness check	Operations + pod lead	Confirms scope, required company inputs, decision makers, data and system access, timing and DI capacity
3 Mutual commitment	Sponsor + company counterpart	Accept responsibilities, availability, escalation path, definition of done and dependencies
4 Delivery	DI engagement owner	Runs work against agreed scope; records decisions and dependency changes; triggers specialist review when conditions change
5 Deployment / handoff	Company owner + DI owner	Defines operator, support expectations, knowledge transfer, access, monitoring and liability / contractual conditions
6 Close / review	Sponsor + Operations	Confirms outcome, open obligations, support owner and lessons; updates portfolio and control records

Escalation triggers

Escalate novel or unclear regulatory responsibility, outbound sensitive data, production use without a named owner, a portfolio company request that materially changes scope, an unsupported deployment, or a disagreement about who owns liability or ongoing support.

E. Financial planning and spend management

A lightweight planning loop that connects priorities, headcount and commitments to an accountable forecast

Element	Minimum operating standard
Purpose	Maintain a current view of expected spend and capacity so DI can make timely tradeoffs without creating a burdensome budgeting process.
Inputs	Approved budget, actuals, workforce plan, active roles, vendor and cloud commitments, renewal dates, planned initiatives and known changes.
Accountable owner	CIO owns DI's forecast and tradeoffs; individual budget, hiring and vendor owners maintain the assumptions behind their commitments.
Corporate partner	Finance validates treatment, provides actuals and planning guidance, and confirms the required approval path for material changes.
Operations role	Consolidates assumptions, maintains the decision calendar, surfaces variance and scenarios, records decisions and coordinates follow-through.
Escalation	Forecast exceeds plan; material unbudgeted commitment; headcount or vendor decision changes delivery capacity; assumption is stale or lacks an owner.
Record	Current forecast, key assumptions, committed and discretionary spend, variance, decision owner, approval status, action and effective date.

Finance operating loop

Mechanism	Lead	Minimum requirement	Output
Maintain baseline	Operations + Finance	Reconcile approved budget, actuals, headcount and contracted commitments; assign an owner to each material assumption.	Current forecast and assumption log
Monthly business and finance review	CIO + Operations	Review variance, hiring outlook, vendor / cloud spend, renewals, initiative changes and emerging risks; focus on decisions, not transaction detail.	Confirmed forecast, decisions, owners and dates
Material change	Budget / business owner	Submit rationale, cost, timing, funding source, delivery impact and alternatives before commitment; Finance confirms approval level.	Approve, defer, reject or reprioritize
Quarterly reset	CIO + Finance	Refresh the outlook and scenarios as strategy, portfolio demand or capacity changes; retire assumptions that are no longer valid.	Updated outlook and explicit tradeoffs

Measures and Guardrails

Track forecast variance, percentage of material spend with a named owner, renewal decisions made before notice dates, and aging approvals. Begin with a spreadsheet or shared tracker; formalize thresholds only after DI and Finance validate decision rights and baseline the volume of changes.

Interaction cadence and escalation

Use the tracker for status and forums for decisions

Mechanism	Frequency	Core participants	Decision agenda	Output
DI operating review	Weekly, 45 minutes	CIO, Operations, pod leads	Portfolio tradeoffs, cross-pod dependencies, people exceptions and urgent operational decisions	Accepted / deferred decisions; owners and dates
Business and finance review	Monthly, 45 minutes	Operations, Finance, CIO / budget owners as needed	Forecast, headcount, material variances, vendor commitments and renewals	Forecast changes; approval actions; renewal decisions
Recruiting and onboarding pulse	Weekly pulse	Operations, HR, active hiring managers; IT by exception	Aging candidates; interview capacity; offers; upcoming starts; access or policy blockers	Next actions; escalations; ready-to-start status
Triggered specialist review	As required; async first	Only required HR, Legal, Compliance, Security, IT or Finance owner	Novel risk, policy exception, unresolved condition or specialist decision	Conditions, decision, approval path or escalation

Supporting async mechanisms

- Recruiting and onboarding: use a shared tracker; add a short weekly pulse only while hiring volume or start-date risk warrants it.
- Vendor renewals: maintain notice dates in the tracker and review upcoming decisions inside the monthly business and finance review.
- Risk and controls: route to specialists when a trigger is present; do not create a standing committee for routine work.

Three-level escalation model

Level	Treatment	Trigger
1. Standard path	Named owner resolves within delegated authority; Operations records next step and follows through.	Routine request; known policy; no material tradeoff
2. Functional escalation	Specialist leader resolves a policy interpretation, risk condition, resource constraint or aging approval.	Service expectation missed; unclear authority; specialist disagreement
3. CIO / executive exception	CIO or executive authority resolves portfolio tradeoffs, accepts material risk, approves policy exception or incremental funding.	Material displacement, risk acceptance, policy exception or unresolved cross-functional impasse

Meeting guardrails

- Cancel a forum when there are no decisions or exceptions; distribute the tracker view asynchronously.
- Do not use specialist functions as standing attendees when a documented trigger has not been met.
- Every agenda item identifies the decision required, decision owner, recommendation and consequence of delay.
- End with recorded decisions, owners and dates; unresolved items move to the appropriate escalation level.

Implementation and measures

Measure whether the interface removes friction

Cross-functional scorecard

Dimension	Initial measures
Intake quality	Percent complete at first submission; return-for-information rate
Routing and flow	Time to acknowledged owner; median cycle time by workflow and tier; requests aging beyond expectation
Decision quality	Decisions with rationale, owner and date; priority changes with explicit displacement
Escalation health	Exception volume; senior escalation rate; repeat exceptions by root cause
People readiness	Candidate time in stage; interview feedback timeliness; day-one baseline access; unresolved day-30 blockers
Spend and vendors	Owned vendor percentage; upcoming renewals with decision; forecast variance; cloud anomaly age
Control execution	Triggered reviews completed before launch; open conditions; overdue access removal or evidence

Implementation Principle

Launch the minimum viable interface in the first 90 days. Start with the shared intake, named owners, visible status and explicit escalation triggers. Baseline volume and cycle time before formalizing service levels or automating workflows. See the 30-60-90 Day Operational Plan for detailed sequencing.

What Operations should not become

The Director of Operations should not be the permanent scheduler, data-entry clerk, proxy approver or owner of every cross-functional transaction. Operations owns the system, standards and exceptions. Requesters maintain their requests; pod and business owners maintain delivery facts; specialist functions own their decisions and evidence. Automation should follow stable workflow—not compensate for unclear ownership.

Shared tracker and minimum information architecture

One source of truth across workflows; lightweight enough to begin in a spreadsheet or simple workflow tool

Minimum Inputs / Information

Field	Minimum content	Why it matters
Request	ID, request type, submitter, sponsor, date submitted	Creates a traceable front door.
Business context	Objective, urgency and date basis	Allows prioritization and proportionate routing.
Ownership	Accountable owner, current action owner, specialist approver where triggered	Prevents work from becoming collectively owned.
Flow	Status, next action, due date, aging and dependencies	Makes progress visible without status meetings.
Risk and controls	Risk tier, triggered reviews, conditions and exceptions	Preserves specialist authority and evidence.
Decision	Decision, rationale, date, decision maker and work displaced	Supports consistency and institutional memory.
Lifecycle	Activation / start date, renewal / review date, ongoing owner, closure outcome	Avoids orphaned access, vendors and obligations.

Minimum Output Views

View	Question answered	Primary user
Intake queue	What is new, incomplete or awaiting triage?	Operations
My actions	What do I owe, by when, and what is blocked?	Owners and specialists
Exceptions and aging	Which items require intervention or escalation?	Operations and CIO
Portfolio and capacity	What is committed, dependent or being displaced?	CIO and pod leads
Lifecycle calendar	Which starts, access changes, renewals or reviews are approaching?	Operations and accountable owners

Information discipline

The tracker is not a second system of record. It stores the minimum cross-functional coordination fields and links to authoritative HR, finance, contracting, security or delivery systems where those exist. Automate only after request patterns, volumes and bottlenecks are understood.